

CHAPTER

1. Passage anchor

> “More importantly, she said she chose a pen because it symbolised a new **chapter**.”

Passage meaning

chapter = a new period or stage in someone’s life, career, relationship, or development
新篇章；新階段

Here, the pen symbolizes the speaker moving from one stage of life into another after finishing important exams.

Practice

1. Starting university felt like a new **chapter** in her life.
開始大學生活就像她人生中的一個**新篇章**。
2. Leaving that job marked the end of one **chapter** and the beginning of another.
離開那份工作標誌著一個**階段的結束**和另一個**階段的開始**。

Core meanings of CHAPTER

2. chapter — section of a book

= one of the main divisions of a book
章；章節

Examples

1. I read three **chapters** last night.
我昨晚讀了三個**章節**。
2. The answer is explained in the final **chapter**.
答案在最後一**章**中有解釋。

This is the central literal meaning.

3. chapter title

= title given to one section of a book

****章名；章節標題****

Examples

1. Each ****chapter title**** reflects the main theme.

每個****章節標題****都反映主要主題。

2. I forgot the name of the ****chapter****.

我忘了那一****章****的名稱。

Figurative life stage

4. chapter — period or stage in life

= a particular period in someone's life or experience

****篇章；階段；時期****

This is the exact passage sense.

Examples

1. Parenthood opened a new ****chapter**** in their lives.

成為父母開啟了他們人生的新****篇章****。

2. That difficult period was an important ****chapter**** in her life.

那段艱難時期是她人生中的重要****階段****。

5. a new chapter

= beginning of a new phase or stage

****新篇章；新階段****

Examples

1. Moving abroad began a ****new chapter**** for him.

搬到海外為他開啟了一個****新篇章****。

2. The graduation ceremony marked the start of a ****new chapter****.

畢業典禮標誌著一個****新階段****的開始。

Very high-value figurative expression.

6. close / end a chapter

= bring a particular period of life or experience to an end

****結束一個篇章；告一段落****

Examples

1. She was ready to ****close that chapter**** of her life.
她已經準備好讓人生的那個****篇章告一段落****。
2. The agreement helped both sides ****end a difficult chapter****.
那份協議幫助雙方****結束了一段艱難時期****。

7. begin / open a chapter

= start a new period or phase

****開啟新篇章****

Examples

1. The move ****opened a new chapter**** in their relationship.
搬家為他們的關係****開啟了新篇章****。
2. She was excited to ****begin a new chapter****.
她很期待****展開新的階段****。

History / larger story

8. chapter — period in history

= a distinct period or episode in the history of a country, organization, field, etc.

****歷史篇章；時期****

Examples

1. The invention opened a new ****chapter in medical history****.
這項發明開啟了醫學史上的一個新****篇章****。
2. It was a dark ****chapter**** in the country's history.
那是該國歷史上一段黑暗的****時期****。

9. a dark chapter

= painful, shameful, or difficult period

****黑暗篇章；艱難時期****

Examples

1. The war remains a ****dark chapter**** in the nation's history.

那場戰爭仍是該國歷史上的一段****黑暗篇章****。

2. She rarely spoke about that ****dark chapter**** of her life.

她很少談及人生中的那段****艱難時期****。

Organization / branch

10. chapter — local branch of an organization

= local division of a larger organization, association, fraternity, charity, etc.

****分會；地方支部****

Examples

1. She joined the local ****chapter**** of the association.

她加入了那個協會的當地****分會****。

2. The university has its own student ****chapter****.

那所大學有自己的學生****分會****。

This is a major distinct noun sense, especially in North American English.

11. local chapter

= local branch of a larger organization

****地方分會****

Examples

1. The ****local chapter**** organized the event.

當地****分會****籌辦了這場活動。

2. He became president of the regional **chapter**.
他成為地區**分會**主席。

Religious / scriptural section

12. chapter — numbered section of a religious text

= one of the numbered divisions of a religious scripture or text
章

Examples

1. Read **chapter five** of the text.
閱讀該文本的第**五章**。

2. The passage comes from the first **chapter**.
這段文字來自第**一章**。

This is structurally the same as the book sense, but useful enough as a distinct high-value context.

Law / bankruptcy

13. Chapter 7 / Chapter 11 etc.

In U.S. legal usage:

= a numbered chapter of federal bankruptcy law, used metonymically for a type of bankruptcy proceeding

《破產法》第 7 章 / 第 11 章等；相應破產程序

Examples

1. The company filed for **Chapter 11** bankruptcy.
公司申請了美國《破產法》第 11 章的**破產保護**。

2. The business entered **Chapter 7** proceedings.
該企業進入第 7 章**破產清算程序**。

Specialist but highly established.

Related forms / compounds

14. chapter heading

= heading at the start of a chapter

****章節標題****

Examples

1. The ****chapter heading**** is printed in bold.

****章節標題****以粗體印刷。

2. Each ****chapter heading**** introduces a new topic.

每個****章節標題****都引入一個新主題。

15. chapter break

= point where one chapter ends and another begins

****章節分隔；換章處****

Examples

1. The editor inserted a ****chapter break**** there.

編輯在那裡加入了****章節分隔****。

2. The scene ends at a natural ****chapter break****.

那個場景在一個自然的****換章處****結束。

High-value expressions

16. turn the page / start a new chapter

Closely linked metaphorically:

= move on from the past and begin a new phase

****翻開新一頁；開展新篇章****

Examples

1. She decided to ****start a new chapter**** after leaving the company.

她離開公司後決定****展開新篇章****。

2. The move helped him **turn the page** and begin again.

搬家幫助他**翻開新一頁**，重新開始。

17. the next chapter

= the next stage in life, work, a project, or a story

下一篇章；下一階段

Examples

1. I'm excited about the **next chapter** of my career.

我很期待職業生涯的**下一階段**。

2. Nobody knew what the **next chapter** would bring.

沒有人知道**下一篇章**會帶來甚麼。

Very relevant to the passage's "what would come next" theme.

Key contrasts

18. chapter vs section

chapter

= major division of a book

章

section

= smaller or more general subdivision of a document, chapter, website, etc.

節；部分

A chapter may contain several sections.

19. chapter vs part

part

= broad division or portion of something

部分；篇

chapter

= more specifically a book/document division or figurative life stage

A book may have:

- * Part I
- * several chapters within that part

20. chapter vs episode

****episode****

= one event in a series, or one installment of a TV/radio series

****事件 ; 一集****

****chapter****

= one section of a book or one phase in a larger story/life

Compare:

> an episode of a TV series

> 一集電視劇

> a chapter of a novel

> 小說的一章

21. chapter vs stage

****stage****

= phase in a process or development

****階段****

****chapter****

= figurative and narrative, often emphasizing that life is like a story

Compare:

> the next ****stage**** of the project

> 專案下一階段

> a new ****chapter**** in my life

> 人生新篇章

22. chapter vs milestone

This passage contains both.

****milestone****

= important point marking progress

****里程碑****

****chapter****

= longer period or phase in the larger story

****篇章 ; 階段****

Compare:

> finishing the exams = a ****milestone****

> 完成考試 = 一個里程碑

> what comes after = a new ****chapter****

> 之後的新人生階段 = 新篇章

A milestone is a ****point****; a chapter is a ****period****.

Meaning map

The central literal concept of ****chapter**** is:

****one major section in a larger book****

That creates a natural metaphor:

****life/history = a book****

so:

Book

chapter

→ ****章 ; 章節****

Life

new chapter

→ ****人生新篇章****

History

dark chapter

→ **歷史中的一段時期**

A separate organizational extension gives:

Organization

local chapter

→ **地方分會**

And legal usage gives:

U.S. bankruptcy law

Chapter 11

→ **《破產法》第 11 章 / 破產保護程序**

The passage uses the figurative life-story branch:

> **symbolised a new chapter**

> → **象徵人生新篇章**

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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chapter — book	一本書中的主要分段；章 / 章節
chapter — life stage	人生、職業、關係等中的一段重要時期；篇章 / 階段
a new chapter	新的生活、工作或發展階段；新篇章
close/end a chapter	讓某一段經歷或時期告一段落
begin/open a chapter	開始一個新的階段；開啟新篇章
chapter — history	歷史或某領域中的一段時期 / 篇章
a dark chapter	一段痛苦、負面或令人羞愧的時期
chapter — organization	大型組織在某地區的分會 / 支部
local chapter	某組織的地方分會
chapter — scripture/text	宗教經典或其他文本中的一章
Chapter 7/11 etc.	美國破產法中的特定章節及相應破產程序
chapter heading	章節開頭的標題
chapter break	一章結束、下一章開始的分隔點
the next chapter	接下來的人生 / 職業 / 發展階段

Passage recap

> “...she chose a pen because it symbolised a new **chapter**.”

Here:

chapter = **a new period or stage in the speaker’s life**

Best Traditional Chinese:

* **新篇章**

* **新階段**

* **人生的新一頁**

Natural contextual translation:

她說她選擇送一支筆，是因為它象徵一個新篇章。

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

chapter

= **a distinct period or stage in a person’s life, viewed metaphorically as part of a larger story**

篇章；階段

The metaphor is especially strong because the gift itself is a **pen**:

> pen

> → used to write

> chapter

> → section of a story

> “write my own story”

> → shape my own life

So the passage deliberately builds one connected metaphor:

the pen symbolizes a new chapter because the speaker is beginning to “write” the next stage of their own life.